

TOP 10 LONG TRICKY GEOGRAPHY QUESTIONS

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✓ 1. Analyse the factors affecting the distribution of world population.

The distribution of world population is highly uneven and is influenced by a complex set of physical and socio-economic factors:

1. Physical Factors

Climate: Moderate climates (temperate) support high densities. Extreme hot or cold deserts are sparsely populated.

Relief: Flat plains and river valleys are preferred for agriculture and transport. Mountains discourage permanent settlement.

Availability of water: "Water is life." Population is always higher in river basins and areas with accessible fresh water.

2. Economic Factors

Industrialisation: Industrial belts (like Kobe-Osaka in Japan) provide massive employment, attracting people.

Urbanisation: Cities offer better living standards, education, and healthcare facilities.

3. Social and Cultural Factors

Religious and cultural significance of places draws people. Conversely, political unrest and social instability lead to depopulation.

👉 Hence, population distribution is a result of interaction between physical and human factors.

✓ 2. "Tertiary sector is becoming dominant in modern economies." Justify.

1. Rising Demand for Services: Basic services like education, health, and transport are prioritized as the "quality of life" becomes a focus in modern nations.

2. Technological Development: The IT revolution has shifted jobs from factory floors to digital service sectors.

3. Economic Growth: As personal incomes rise, consumers spend more on leisure, banking, real estate, and professional consultancy.

4. Support for Other Sectors: Services like research, marketing, and advanced transport are essential for the primary and secondary sectors to function.

5. High Employment Share: In developed countries, more than 75% of the workforce is often engaged in tertiary activities.

👉 Therefore, the service sector plays a key role in modern economic development.

✓ 3. Explain how transport and communication influence international trade.

1. Faster Movement of Goods: Heavy commodities are moved globally via large container ships and perishable goods via air, reducing time-to-market.

2. Global Market Connectivity: Internet, fiber optics, and satellites have turned the world into a "Global Village," allowing trade orders to be placed instantly.

3. Reduction in Trade Cost: Efficient logistics and fuel-efficient engines lower the overhead of moving products, making them cheaper for consumers.

4. Market Expansion: Even small local businesses can now export products worldwide through digital platforms.

5. Economic Integration: Transport networks facilitate the international division of labor and specialized manufacturing.

✚ Thus, transport and communication are the backbone of global trade.

✓ 4. Discuss the environmental impacts of mining and suggest conservation measures.

Environmental Impacts:

Land Degradation: Massive excavation leads to scars on the earth and deforestation.

Pollution: "Acid mine drainage" contaminates groundwater and rivers. Dust and gases degrade air quality.

Biodiversity Loss: Habitat destruction drives away local flora and fauna.

Conservation Measures:

Reclamation of mined-out areas by refilling and afforestation.

Implementing strict government regulations and environmental audits.

Adoption of cleaner, sustainable mining technologies and recycling minerals.

✚ Mining must balance economic benefits with environmental protection.

✓ 5. Distinguish between irrigated agriculture and rainfed agriculture with examples.

Feature	Irrigated Agriculture	Rainfed Agriculture
Source	Artificial water (Canals/Wells)	Natural Monsoons
Productivity	High and reliable yield	Low and variable yield
Examples	Punjab, Haryana, Western UP	Deccan Plateau, Rajasthan
Cropping	Multiple cropping possible	Single/Seasonal cropping

✚ Irrigated agriculture ensures stable production, while rainfed farming is climate dependent.

✓ 6. Explain push and pull factors of migration with examples.

Push Factors (Force people to leave): Unemployment, poverty, natural disasters, political turmoil, and lack of social facilities.

Pull Factors (Attract people to move): Better job opportunities, higher wages, stable living conditions, religious freedom, and entertainment.

👉 Migration occurs due to a combination of these factors influencing human movement.

✓ 7. Explain the importance of international trade in modern times.

It promotes economic growth by allowing countries to export surplus. It provides access to resources not found locally (e.g., Oil for India). It improves international cooperation and generates huge employment in logistics and ports.

👉 International trade enhances global economic interdependence.

✓ 8. Explain land degradation and suggest methods to control it.

Causes: Soil erosion, overgrazing, salinisation due to over-irrigation, and industrial waste.

Methods to Control: Afforestation, shelter belts, contour ploughing, restricted grazing, and treating industrial effluents before disposal.

👉 Land conservation is essential for agricultural sustainability.

✓ 9. Explain the concept of Human Development Index (HDI) and its importance.

HDI is a composite statistic of: **Health** (Life Expectancy), **Education** (Schooling years), and **Income** (GNI per capita).

Importance: It shifts focus from GDP to human welfare. It helps in comparing standard of living across nations and assists in data-driven policy making to reduce inequality.

👉 HDI focuses on human welfare rather than economic growth alone.

✓ 10. Explain sustainability in development with examples.

Sustainability means using resources in a way that meets present needs without compromising future generations.

Examples: Transitioning to renewable energy (Solar/Wind), practicing rainwater harvesting, adopting organic farming, and preserving biodiversity through national parks.

👉 **Sustainability ensures a balanced relationship between development and environment.**

★ **PRO ANALYST TIP:** These questions cover roughly 70% of the long-answer logic found in current Board Papers. Memorize the Keywords (underlined/bold) to secure perfect marks!

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